



MarkingForge

Preset packs - ready-made dials for modelling, animation, look-dev and archviz

3DS MAX 2027 · VERSION 1.4.4

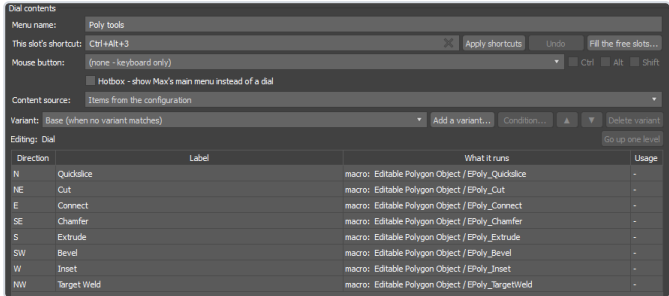
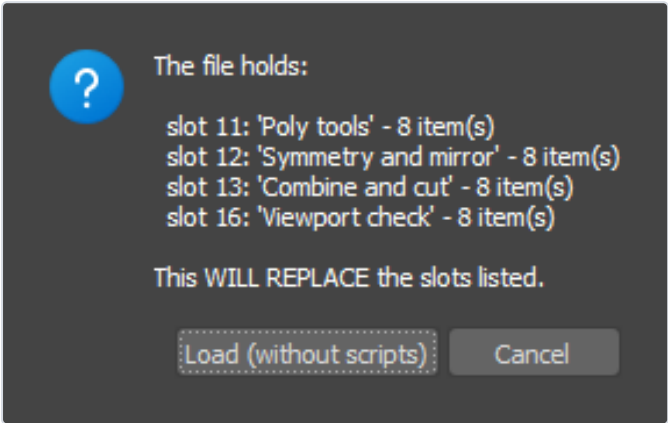
Four sets of dials for one kind of work each. A pack replaces only the dials it names and leaves the rest of your layout as it is. Load one, try it for a day, keep what works - or take a single dial of a pack from the dial library.

Contents

1. Loading a pack
2. Modelling pack
3. Animation pack
4. LookDev pack
5. Archviz pack
6. Make your own pack
7. Support, bug reports and feature requests

Loading a pack

- 1 Open **MarkingForge > Menu editor...**
- 2 Press **Load preset...** at the bottom and open a file from the **Presets** folder of the download.
- 3 The editor lists the dials the pack replaces - read it and press **Load (without scripts)**; the packs have none.
- 4 Look at the dials in the editor, then press **Save**. The dials change at once - no restart.



After loading: dial 11 is now Poly tools.

Before loading: the dials the Modelling pack will replace.

Want your dials back? Before saving: **Reload from file** throws the pack away. After saving, one dial at a time: **Dial library... > Built-in dials, as shipped > the dial (say Menu 11 - Show and hide) > Put on Menu 11**. All of them: **Load default dials...** (tick *Replace the slots that already have a menu as well*) restores the whole built-in layout. Or keep a copy of your own before trying a pack: **Save every dial...** (every dial with its sets and colours - **Load every dial...** puts it back) or **Save preset...**

The packs contain only 3ds Max commands - no scripts - so nothing is removed when they load, and every command was checked against a stock 2027 release of 3ds Max.

One dial of a pack - the dial library

Every dial of the four packs is also a file of its own, in the editor's dial library and in **Dials\Packs** of the download. Take only the one you want, on any key:

- 1 Select the dial in the editor's list of dials and press **Dial library...** (or right-click the dial > **Put a dial from the library on Menu N...**).
- 2 Open *From the preset packs* and pick a dial - *Modelling: Poly tools*, say. Its drawing shows on the right.
- 3 **Put on Menu N** replaces what the dial shows (its key and mouse button stay). **Add as a new set of Menu N** keeps it: the key still opens what it opened, and the pack's dial is the next page - hold the key and turn the mouse wheel.
- 4 **Save**.

The packs at a glance

Pack	For	Replaces
Modelling MarkingForge_Pack_Modelling.json	Hard-surface and poly modelling: the poly tools on one key whatever the sub-object level, symmetry and mirror tools,	Poly tools (Ctrl+Alt+3, was: Show and hide), Symmetry and mirror (Ctrl+Alt+4, was: Viewports), Combine

	combining and cutting, and a viewport check dial.	and cut (Ctrl+Alt+5, was: Viewport display), Viewport check (Ctrl+Alt+8, was: Render)
Animation MarkingForge_Pack_Animation.json	Keyframing: transform with the animation coordinate systems, every key command, playback and time, curves, tangents and layers - with Track View commands when the cursor is over Track View.	Animate transform (Ctrl+Alt+1, was: Transform), Keys (Ctrl+Alt+4, was: Viewports), Playback and time (Ctrl+Alt+8, was: Render), Curves and layers (Shift+Alt+2, was: Animation)
LookDev MarkingForge_Pack_LookDev.json	Look development: viewport shading and overrides, light display and shadows, camera controls.	Shading (Ctrl+Alt+5, was: Viewport display), Lights (Shift+Alt+7, was: Tools and setup), Cameras (Shift+Alt+8, was: Lights and cameras)
Archviz MarkingForge_Pack_Archviz.json	Architectural visualisation and layout: placing, arraying and aligning, snaps, layers and groups, references and files.	Place and array (Ctrl+Alt+1, was: Transform), Snaps (Ctrl+Alt+6, was: Snaps and grid), Layers and groups (Shift+Alt+3, was: Scene), References and files (Shift+Alt+4, was: File)

Modelling pack

Hard-surface and poly modelling: the poly tools on one key whatever the sub-object level, symmetry and mirror tools, combining and cutting, and a viewport check dial.

File: Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_Modelling.json

Ctrl+Alt+3 Poly tools

dial 11 - replaces Show and hide

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Poly tools* - file Dials\Packs\Modelling - Poly tools.mfdial

NW Target Weld	N Quickslice	NE Cut
W Inset	Poly tools	E Connect
SW Bevel	S Extrude	SE Chamfer

List under the dial: Swift Loop · Remove Loop · Flow Connect · Distance Connect · Make planar · Tessellate · Hinge · Outline

Ctrl+Alt+4 Symmetry and mirror

dial 12 - replaces Viewports

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Symmetry and mirror* - file Dials\Packs\Modelling - Symmetry and mirror.mfdial

NW + Mirror	N + Symmetry	NE Symmetry tools
W - to +	Symmetry and mirror	E + to -
SW Copy	S Flip	SE Paste

List under the dial: Mirror element X · Mirror element Y · Mirror element Z · Symmetry select X · Mirror (object)...

Ctrl+Alt+5 Combine and cut

dial 13 - replaces Viewport display

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Combine and cut* - file Dials\Packs\Modelling - Combine and cut.mfdial

NW + Cap Holes	N ProCutter	NE ShapeMerge
W + Welder	Combine and cut	E Connect
SW Snapshot...	S Collapse stack	SE Attach

List under the dial: Detach · + Vertex Weld · + Slice · + Chamfer

Ctrl+Alt+8

Viewport check

dial 16 - replaces Render

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Viewport check* - file `Dials\Packs\Modelling - Viewport check.mfdial`

NW Zoom selected	N Edged faces	NE See-through
W Wireframe / shaded	Viewport check	E Statistics
SW Backface cull	S Isolate	SE Edges only

List under the dial: Clay · Realistic with maps · Default shading · Wireframe · Vertex ticks

Animation pack

Keyframing: transform with the animation coordinate systems, every key command, playback and time, curves, tangents and layers - with Track View commands when the cursor is over Track View.

File: Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_Animation.json

Ctrl+Alt+1 Animate transform

dial 9 - replaces Transform

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Animate transform* - file Dials\Packs\Animation - Animate transform.mfdial

NW Coords: world	N Move	NE Rotate
W Coords: local	Animate transform	E Scale
SW Coords: parent	S Freeze transform	SE Coords: gimbal

List under the dial: Freeze position · Freeze rotation · Link · Unlink · Select parent · Select child

Ctrl+Alt+4 Keys

dial 12 - replaces Viewports

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Keys* - file Dials\Packs\Animation - Keys.mfdial

NW Key mode	N Key all	NE Key position
W Auto Key	Keys	E Key rotation
SW Set Key mode	S Set keys	SE Key scale

List under the dial: Key pos, rot, scale · Set key selected · Clear Set Key buffer · Create key

Ctrl+Alt+8 Playback and time

dial 16 - replaces Render

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Playback and time* - file Dials\Packs\Animation - Playback and time.mfdial

NW Ghosting	N Play	NE Next frame
W Previous frame	Playback and time	E Go to end
SW Go to start	S Motion paths	SE Time configuration...

List under the dial: SMPTE / frames · Show key times

Shift+Alt+2 Curves and layers

dial 18 - replaces Animation

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Curves and layers* - file `Dials\Packs\Animation - Curves and layers.mfdial`

NW Merge animation...	N Track View	NE Animation layers...
W Default tangent: stepped	Curves and layers	E Default tangent: linear
SW Reaction manager...	S Default tangent: auto	SE Default tangent: smooth

List under the dial: Default tangent: spline · Default tangent: fast · Default tangent: slow · Save animation... · Load animation...

Changes to **Track View** when cursor over Track View.

LookDev pack

Look development: viewport shading and overrides, light display and shadows, camera controls.

File: `Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_LookDev.json`

Ctrl+Alt+5 Shading

dial 13 - replaces Viewport display

Alone, from the dial library: *LookDev: Shading* - file `Dials\Packs\LookDev - Shading.mfdial`

NW Fast shader	N Realistic with maps	NE Realistic, no maps
W Override off	Shading	E Shaded with maps
SW Clay	S Default shading	SE UV checker

List under the dial: Override: render setting · Lit wireframes · Hidden line · Transparency: best · Default / scene lights

Shift+Alt+7 Lights

dial 23 - replaces Tools and setup

Alone, from the dial library: *LookDev: Lights* - file `Dials\Packs\LookDev - Lights.mfdial`

NW Lock lights	N Light Explorer	NE Shadows on
W Light view	Lights	E Default / scene lights
SW Only selected lights	S Hide lights	SE Shadows off

List under the dial: Unlock lights · Select lighting lights · Select shadow lights · Add default lights · Environment...

Shift+Alt+8 Cameras

dial 24 - replaces Lights and cameras

Alone, from the dial library: *LookDev: Cameras* - file `Dials\Packs\LookDev - Cameras.mfdial`

NW Roll	N Camera view	NE Match camera to view
W Dolly	Cameras	E Safe frames
SW Field of view	S Hide cameras	SE Align camera

List under the dial: Truck · Pan camera · Select camera · Select target · Viewport camera 1 · More cameras...

Archviz pack

Architectural visualisation and layout: placing, arraying and aligning, snaps, layers and groups, references and files.

File: `Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_Archviz.json`

Ctrl+Alt+1 Place and array

dial 9 - replaces Transform

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: Place and array* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz - Place and array.mfdial`

NW Align...	N Place	NE Array...
W Clone	Place and array	E Spacing tool...
SW Mirror...	S Snapshot...	SE Clone and align...

List under the dial: Quick align · Normal align... · Type-in... · + Array modifier

Ctrl+Alt+6 Snaps

dial 14 - replaces Snaps and grid

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: Snaps* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz - Snaps.mfdial`

NW AutoGrid	N Snaps	NE Angle snap
W Cycle snap type	Snaps	E Percent snap
SW Axis constraints	S Snap to frozen	SE Snap settings...

List under the dial: Spinner snap · Align grid to view · Hide grids · Grid top · Grid front

Shift+Alt+3 Layers and groups

dial 19 - replaces Scene

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: Layers and groups* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz - Layers and groups.mfdial`

NW Scene Explorer	N New layer	NE Add to layer
W Layer Explorer	Layers and groups	E Select layer
SW Freeze layer	S Hide layer	SE Isolate layer

List under the dial: Group · Ungroup · Open group · Close group · Attach to group · Detach from group

Changes to **Scene Explorer** when cursor over the Scene Explorer.

Shift+Alt+4 **References and files**

dial 20 - replaces File

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: References and files* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz - References and files.mfdial`

NW Summary info...	N XRef scene...	NE XRef objects...
W Save incremental	References and files	E Merge...
SW Archive...	S Import...	SE Replace...

List under the dial: Save · Export... · Export selected... · Save selected... · Project paths...

Make your own pack

- 1 Arrange the dials you want to share in the editor.
- 2 **Save preset...** writes your layout to one file - without usage data or paths.
- 3 To share only some dials, remove the others from the file in a text editor: a preset replaces exactly the dials it holds (keys "1" to "24" under "menus").
- 4 Scripts in a preset are removed when somebody else loads it, unless they choose **Load WITH the scripts** - wherever they sit: directions, list rows, the tap item, submenus and variants. Prefer 3ds Max commands for anything you share.

A preset holds what each dial shows, with that dial's own colours - not a dial's other sets (the pages under the mouse wheel) and not the colours set for every dial. Two other ways to share:

- **One dial: Save dial...**, or right-click the dial > **Save Menu N (...) to a file...** - a `.mfdial` file, loaded with **Load dial...** in place of a dial or as a new set of it.
- **Everything: Save every dial...** writes every dial and every set to a dated folder, with the colours of every dial; **Load every dial...** puts it all back. Scripts in these files are removed on loading too, unless the person loading them keeps them.
- **A colour look to go with it: Colours... > Presets > Export this preset to a file...** (a `.mfcolors` file; **Import a preset from a file...** on the other side).

Support, bug reports and feature requests

ISSUES	github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues
E-MAIL	forgeplugins@gmail.com
WEB	https://forgeplugins.tech (forgeplugins.tech - more plugins by the author)

Bug reports and feature requests are best opened as issues on GitHub - the forms there ask for exactly what is needed, and you can follow the fix. Questions, and anything you would rather not post publicly (licence, purchase), go to the e-mail address. Every message is read.

Reporting a bug

- 1 In 3ds Max choose **MarkingForge > Report a bug...** - it copies your 3ds Max version, MarkingForge version, configuration summary and start-up log to the clipboard. It works even when the plugin did not load.
- 2 Open github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues and pick **Bug report** - or answer **Yes** in the dialog to write an e-mail to forgeplugins@gmail.com instead.
- 3 Say what you did, what you expected and what happened instead, then paste the details with **Ctrl+V**.
- 4 Add a screenshot if you can. When the problem is in one dial, attach a preset of it (editor > **Save preset...**).

Suggesting a feature

Open an issue with the **Feature request** form, choose **MarkingForge > Suggest a feature...**, or simply write. Describe what you would like to do and how you do it today - a concrete example from your work says more than a list of wishes. Ideas for new built-in dials, commands and options are all welcome.

Nothing is sent by the plugin itself: the details go to the clipboard and your own e-mail program, so you see everything that leaves your computer. MarkingForge has no network access.